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INDIA IN CHINA'S GRAND STRATEGY

Change and continuity from 1949 to present

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Examining change and continuity in China's policy towards India from the foundation of the People's Republic in 1949 to the present time, this chapter explores if China now attaches more or less importance to India and whether it pursues a more benign or assertive policy towards India. India has never constituted China's main security challenge, and China's policy on India thus has to be understood and analysed within the larger context of Beijing's overarching foreign policy outlook at any given time, as the role and position of India evolves according to changes in China's grand strategy.

Grand strategy, in the simplest terms, is a state's theory about how it can best create security for itself,[1] and in an anarchical global system, states seek power to survive.[2] Power is basically the material resources available to a state in the form of economic wealth and military capabilities.[3] The ways that a country follows in its foreign policy in search